

HINT 365 · Owner costs and earnings (AI features)

What the owner spends and earns with the AI features: the 15-day trial, then the 4.99 US\$ yearly subscription. Estimates made on 02.10.2026 for the decision of Human (terms v21). The real figures are:

- in the web **Admin** console, tables *Usage* and *Income and expenses* (month by month, from `ai_spend_daily` and `sub_sales_daily`);
- in the AI provider's console (usage and the monthly spend limit);
- in the Google Play Console (earnings).

The rules these numbers follow

Rule	Value	Where in the code
The app (voice, lab results, charts, reports, Web Dashboard)	free	no gate on the subscription
AI features trial	15 days from the first Scan, once per Google account and per phone	<code>TRIAL_DAYS</code> , table <code>scan_trials</code>
Scans a day, trial and subscription	3 per person (the owner: 30)	<code>SCAN_FREE</code> , <code>SCAN_PLUS</code>
Subscription	4.99 US\$ a year, through Google Play	<code>hint365_annual</code> , <code>SUB_PRICE_CENTS</code>
Yearly AI allowance per subscriber	2.50 US\$, counted from the tokens the provider reports, in D1	<code>SCAN_YEAR_USD</code> , table <code>scan_usage</code>
AI key	only the owner's, in the secret <code>AI_API_KEY</code> (today an Anthropic key); nobody adds their own	<code>build.yml</code> , Worker secret
Overall spend limit	set by the owner in the AI provider's console	outside the code

Cost of one Scan

Item	Assumption
Model	Claude Haiku 4.5, list price 1 US\$ per million input tokens, 5 US\$ per million output tokens
Photo	1280 × 960 px after the app shrinks it ≈ 1,640 tokens (width × height / 750)
Instructions	≈ 160 tokens
Answer	≈ 25 tokens (three numbers in JSON)
One Scan	$1,800 \times 1 \mu\$ + 25 \times 5 \mu\$ \approx \mathbf{0.002 \text{ US\$ (0.2 cents)}}$

A retake is a new Scan and costs the same; it counts in the 3 a day. For comparison, the same Scan with Claude Opus would cost about 0.012 US\$, six times more.

Daily use profiles used below: **light** 1 Scan a day, **typical** 2, **maximum** 3 (the limit).

Trial: owner's exposure

Each person costs the owner at most 45 Scans, once in their life (15 days × 3).

Users in trial	Light (15 Scans each)	Typical (30)	Maximum (45)
1	0.03 US\$	0.06 US\$	0.09 US\$
100	3 US\$	6 US\$	9 US\$
200	6 US\$	12 US\$	18 US\$

A second phone or a new account does not start a new trial, so 100 people cannot cost more than about 9 US\$.

The ceiling at the AI provider decides. What the owner can really spend is the smaller of the two: the estimate above and the ceiling set in the provider's console (prepaid credit, auto-reload off, monthly spend limit).

Ceiling set at Anthropic	100 users in trial: owner spends at most
5 US\$	5 US\$ (the Scan stops at the ceiling; voice keeps working)
9 US\$	9 US\$
10 US\$	9 US\$ (100 trials cannot use more)

The web Admin console shows the same estimate for the users there really are (*maximum trial cost*), next to what came in, what the AI cost and how many users there are, so the owner can keep the proportion in view.

After the trial: one subscriber, one year

	Light	Typical	Maximum
Scans a year	365	730	1,095
Owner's AI cost	0.73 US\$	1.46 US\$	2.19 US\$
Price paid	4.99 US\$	4.99 US\$	4.99 US\$
Google Play fee (15% on subscriptions)	-0.75 US\$	-0.75 US\$	-0.75 US\$
Owner keeps (price without tax)	3.51 US\$	2.78 US\$	2.05 US\$
Owner keeps if the 4.99 US\$ include 20% VAT (net 3.53 US\$)	2.80 US\$	2.07 US\$	1.34 US\$

With Haiku a subscriber can never cost more than 2.19 US\$ a year: the 3 a day limit stops first. The 2.50 US\$ allowance (about 1,250 Scans at today's price) matters only if the model becomes more expensive. With Opus, for example, it would stop the Scan after about 200 Scans in the year. The app shows the subscriber how many Scans are left, estimated from their own recorded use.

People who do not subscribe cost the owner nothing after the trial: voice, lab results and the dashboard use no AI.

At full speed: 200 people with the app

All 200 have used their trial (once: 12 to 18 US\$). The table is per year, for three shares of subscribers.

	10% subscribe (20)	25% subscribe (50)	50% subscribe (100)
Paid by subscribers	99.80 US\$	249.50 US\$	499.00 US\$
After the Google Play fee	84.83 US\$	212.08 US\$	424.15 US\$
AI cost, typical use	29.20 US\$	73.00 US\$	146.00 US\$
AI cost, everybody at the maximum	43.80 US\$	109.50 US\$	219.00 US\$
Owner keeps, typical	55.63 US\$	139.08 US\$	278.15 US\$
Owner keeps, everybody at the maximum	41.03 US\$	102.58 US\$	205.15 US\$
Owner keeps at the maximum, if prices include 20% VAT	26.80 US\$	67.00 US\$	134.00 US\$

Other costs, outside the table:

Item	Cost
Google Play developer account	25 US\$ once
Cloudflare Workers and D1	free plan (100,000 requests a day) is enough for 200 people; the paid plan is 5 US\$ a month if ever needed
The owner's own Scans (up to 30 a day)	about 1.46 US\$ a year at 2 a day; at most 22 US\$ a year at 30 a day
Trial of each new person	at most 0.09 US\$, once

With the free Cloudflare plan every subscriber leaves a margin. With the paid plan (60 US\$ a year) the break-even is about 22 subscribers at typical use.

What protects the owner

1. 3 Scans a day per person, on the server: a 4th request never reaches the AI provider.
2. One trial per Google account and per phone.
3. At most 2.50 US\$ of AI per subscriber a year, recorded in D1 from the provider's token count.
4. The AI provider's own ceiling: prepaid credit with **auto-reload off**, and the monthly spend limit (Anthropic Console → Settings → Limits). Above it the provider refuses and the Scan says to use voice: nothing more can be spent. When this happens the server logs `ai_no_credit`: it appears in the next morning's error-log issue and, in orange, in the Admin console, with the advice to top up. The provider has no API that tells the remaining prepaid credit, so the Admin console shows what the Scans cost (counted by HINT 365) and the provider's console shows the balance. Every other AI provider used in the future needs the same ceiling set at the provider.
5. The terms let the owner change prices, limits and free parts, or withdraw the app.
6. The owner's powers and these figures are visible only from the owner's phone (owner code on a new phone).

Where the owner can lose money

Only in the trial: people who try the Scan and never subscribe cost up to 0.09 US\$ each, once, with no income. 100 such people cost at most 9 US\$. Every subscriber covers their own AI (at most 2.50 US\$ against 4.24 US\$ after Google Play, 3.53 US\$ if the price includes 20% VAT). Everything, trial included, stops at the provider's ceiling.

Limits of this estimate

- Token counts are estimates: the Admin console and the provider's console give the real ones after the first Scans.
- Income in the Admin console is counted at the list price (4.99 US\$) when Google Play confirms a new paid year; local prices, taxes and refunds are only in the Google Play Console.
- Prices are Anthropic's list prices on the day of writing; the model may change (SCAN_MODEL).
- How well Haiku reads real displays is still to be measured. If it is not good enough and the model goes back to Opus, the AI cost per Scan rises about six times and the 2.50 US\$ allowance becomes the real limit.